

5 writing workarounds that help most adults with dyslexia

None of these need a diagnosis first. Start with whichever one solves the problem you hit most often.

1 Talk it, then type it

Use voice dictation for a first draft instead of typing from a blank page. Getting ideas down without the friction of spelling and typing removes the biggest barrier — you can tidy the wording once it exists.

2 Read it back to yourself

Run finished writing through text-to-speech before you send it. Dyslexic readers often don't 'hear' their own mistakes when reading silently — hearing the words out loud catches what your eyes skip past.

3 Simplify before you send

Run a plain-English pass over anything important — an email, a report, a form. Shorter sentences and simpler words are faster to write, faster to read, and much easier to proofread.

4 Keep a personal phrase bank

Save the openers, sign-offs, and stock sentences you reuse often so you're never rebuilding the same sentence structure from a blank page.

5 Use a checker built for dyslexia

Standard spellcheckers miss the errors dyslexic writers make most — reversed letters and homophones like their/there or form/from. A dyslexia-aware checker catches what a generic one won't.

How to ask your employer or school to fund assistive tech

If you're working

In the UK, the government's Access to Work scheme funds assessments, software, and equipment for employees with dyslexia — typically the full cost, and it doesn't require a diagnosis to start a claim. Tell your line manager or HR; it's a grant, not special treatment, and it won't affect sick pay or your record.

If you're at school or college

Ask to speak to the SENCO about an access arrangements assessment — it can unlock extra time, a reader or scribe, and assistive software for exams and coursework. Schools hold discretionary SEN budgets for exactly this, and can apply for extra funding if needs are higher.

A script to open the conversation:

"I think I'd write faster and more confidently with some assistive software — can we look at funding it through [Access to Work / the SEN budget]?"